

Trump: Tariffs will start Tuesday

25% levies are planned for Canada and Mexico, another 10% for China

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

President Donald Trump said Thursday that tariffs on goods from Canada and Mexico will increase sharply on Tuesday and, in an unexpected move, also announced an additional 10 percent tax on Chinese goods that will take effect then.

In a post on his social media site, Truth Social, the president said he was acting to confront a continuing influx of illicit drugs.

“Drugs are still pouring into our Country from Mexico and Canada at very high and unacceptable levels. A large percentage of these Drugs, much of them in the form of Fentanyl, are made in, and supplied by, China,” the president wrote. “We cannot allow this scourge to continue to harm the USA.”

In early February, Trump announced 25 percent levies on Canadian and Mexican merchandise and then delayed them by one month after discussions with the heads of those countries. The new 10 percent tax on Chinese goods that he declared Thursday is in addition to a 10 percent levy that took effect in early February.

The latest action will bring the total import fee on some Chinese goods to 45 percent.

In recent days, Trump has given conflicting signals about his plans, appearing to suggest as recently as Wednesday that the Canada and Mexico tariffs might be delayed again until early April.

But while talks continue with Canadian and Mexican diplomats, a White House official reiterated that Trump is set on imposing the new import taxes.

SEE **TARIFFS** ON A11

Windsor, Ontario: Canada’s auto capital is rattled by tariffs. **A11**

Delicate diplomatic outreach on Ukraine



DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

British Prime Minister Keir Starmer, left, is the latest U.S. ally to meet with President Donald Trump and strive to keep the United States from turning on Ukraine and Europe before peace talks with Russia. In Washington, Starmer deployed a mixture of flattery, deference and even a royal invitation for a state visit. **Story, A9**

Signs of GOP unease on legality of Trump freeze

BY LIZ GOODWIN

A handful of Republican senators have joined their Democratic colleagues in expressing alarm over the Trump administration’s foreign aid freeze and gutting of USAID, writing to Marco Rubio that they believe the State Department is not operating in accordance with the law by neglecting to notify and consult with Congress during the process, according to correspondence obtained by The Washington Post.

The senators have also asked Rubio to defend the freeze in a hearing on Capitol Hill in the coming weeks.

The letters were dated earlier this month and sent by members of the Senate Appropriations Committee. They mark some of the first signs of meaningful — if private — GOP pushback to the Trump administration’s striking encroachment on Congress’s power of the purse and betray some frustration with Rubio’s lack of responsiveness to his former colleagues.

Donald Trump and billionaire Elon Musk’s U.S. DOGE Service have frozen and canceled hundreds of billions of dollars in federal spending that’s been appropriated by Congress, sparking a flurry of lawsuits and yet

SEE **FREEZE** ON A4

Reports on aid cutbacks held amid reprisal fears

BY LISA REIN AND JOHN HUDSON

The watchdog for the U.S. Agency for International Development has yet to release two critical reports on the consequences of President Donald Trump’s funding freeze on crucial services in Africa and the Middle East, amid fears of retaliation from the White House, according to interviews and documents obtained by The Washington Post.

One of the unreleased reports says the cutbacks threaten the ceasefire deal between Israel and Hamas in the Gaza Strip, jeopardizing more than \$300 million in humanitarian aid for the devas-

tated Palestinian enclave, according to three people familiar with the situation, who like others spoke on the condition of anonymity to talk about sensitive matters.

And an unpublished global audit found security dangers, risks of widespread looting and disease, and tens of millions of dollars in new costs brought about by the withdrawal of foreign aid and mass relocation of USAID staff, according to documents and interviews. Conditions are particularly dire across southern Africa,

SEE **USAID** ON A4

High court: Pause on USAID payment order may proceed. **A4**

She hoped for change, but not like this

A Michigan woman thought Trump would make IVF free. Instead, his administration fired her.

BY EMILY DAVIES

BALDWIN, MICH. — Ryleigh Cooper exhaled as she slid onto the couch after nine hours of work for the U.S. Forest Service, still covered in the blue paint she used to mark trees for local loggers. Then she got the text.

“I hate to be the bearer of bad news,” her union leader wrote.

It was the second Thursday in February, and a historic White House purge aimed at federal workers like Cooper was sweeping the country. But the headlines felt far away from her life in rural Michigan. She figured her job, with paychecks totaling about \$40,000 a year, would be safe from the cost-cutting campaign led by President Donald Trump and billionaire Elon Musk.

Besides, motherhood was her most pressing concern. Cooper, 24, and her husband were trying to get pregnant, but the doctor said that IVF might be their best chance. Trump had promised to make it free. That is what she thought about in the voting booth.

Now she was staring at her phone, learning that probationary workers in the Forest Service were the next to be fired by his



KYLE MONK/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Ryleigh Cooper worked for the U.S. Forest Service before she was fired this month in a purge of probationary workers.

administration. Cooper was likely to be one of them, her union head told her.

Her eyes watered. She knew it wasn’t personal. Every day brought new rumors of cuts, and her performance evaluation from last fall found her “fully successful” — the highest possible score. She reminded herself that she had done everything right: graduated college with a 3.5 GPA, finished her first semester of work toward a master’s degree in forestry with a 4.0, rescued two dogs and two cats from the local shelter, chosen a man who held her on the shower floor when she found out she had endometriosis, a condition that can lead to infertility, and told her, “It’s okay, there is more than one way to be a parent.”

She thought about the Facebook posts she had seen a few days earlier.

“It’s February 3,” her grandmother posted, “and we’re going in the right direction.”

“Any government employee who is afraid of transparency,” wrote the man who taught her AP government class in high school, “is a criminal!”

Cooper knew the people in her

SEE **COOPER** ON A6

GENE HACKMAN 1930-2025

Actor lent great depth to common-man roles

BY FRANZ LIDZ

Gene Hackman, an actor who powerfully embodied ordinary men under stress in dozens of films and twice won Oscars for bringing humanizing depth to corrupt lawmen, from the raging cop in “The French Connection” to the ruthless sheriff in “Unforgiven,” was found dead Feb. 26 along with his wife at their home in Santa Fe, New Mexico. He was 95.

Mr. Hackman and Betsy Arakawa’s cause of death was not yet known, but the local sheriff’s office said in a news release that there were no signs of foul play. Officers suspected that Mr. Hackman may have “suddenly fallen,” according to an affidavit obtained by The Washington Post.

A 6-foot-2 former Marine, Mr. Hackman was an imposing man with a curly nimbus of receding hair and a jowly potato face that he called “your everyday mine worker’s mug.” He was peerless at conveying frustration and throttled rage, but he showed glim-



EVENING STANDARD/GETTY IMAGES

The career of Gene Hackman, seen in 1973, spanned 100 screen credits and four decades.

mers of romantic warmth and a deft, if underused, comic flair. His onetime director and three-time co-star Warren Beatty praised his “broad spectrum of gifts, a combination of sensitivity and toughness.”

Undeniably charismatic, he rose to screen prominence at a moment when unconventional leading men — Dustin Hoffman, Elliott Gould, Robert De Niro, Al

SEE **HACKMAN** ON A16

Death investigation: Hackman, wife were dead for some time. **A16**

Appreciation: A chameleonic everyman with charisma. **C1**

IN THE NEWS

Anti-Trump resistance After an initial period of stunned confusion, protesters are packing meetings, states are suing and Democrats are preparing for a budget showdown. **A5**

Andrew Tate back in U.S. The influencer and his brother, both charged with trafficking, were allowed to leave Romania. **A8**

THE NATION **Openly transgender** troops will be removed from the military soon, the Pentagon said. **A2** **A federal meeting** meant to help select next winter’s flu vaccine was canceled. **A3**

THE WORLD **Thailand** has repatriated 40 Uyghur Muslims to China despite human rights concerns. **A8** **The jailed leader** of a Kurdish militant group in Turkey told his movement to dissolve. **A9**

THE ECONOMY **The FAA** is close to pulling a \$2.4 billion air traffic contract from Verizon and awarding it to Elon Musk’s Starlink, insiders say. **A10** **Eli Lilly** said it will build three U.S. manufacturing plants to make the key raw ingredients in its medicines. **A10**

THE REGION **Amanda F. Chase**, a former Virginia state senator and MAGA provocateur, joined the GOP race to become the next governor. **B1** **Northern Virginia** residents have questions and concerns after a sex offender accessed local schools’ locker rooms. **B1**

STYLE **Restaurants** that specialize in egg dishes are scrambling to deal with increased costs amid the avian flu outbreak. **C1**

WEEKEND **Let the good times** roll with parades, brass bands, dances and other Mardi Gras offerings in the D.C. area.

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